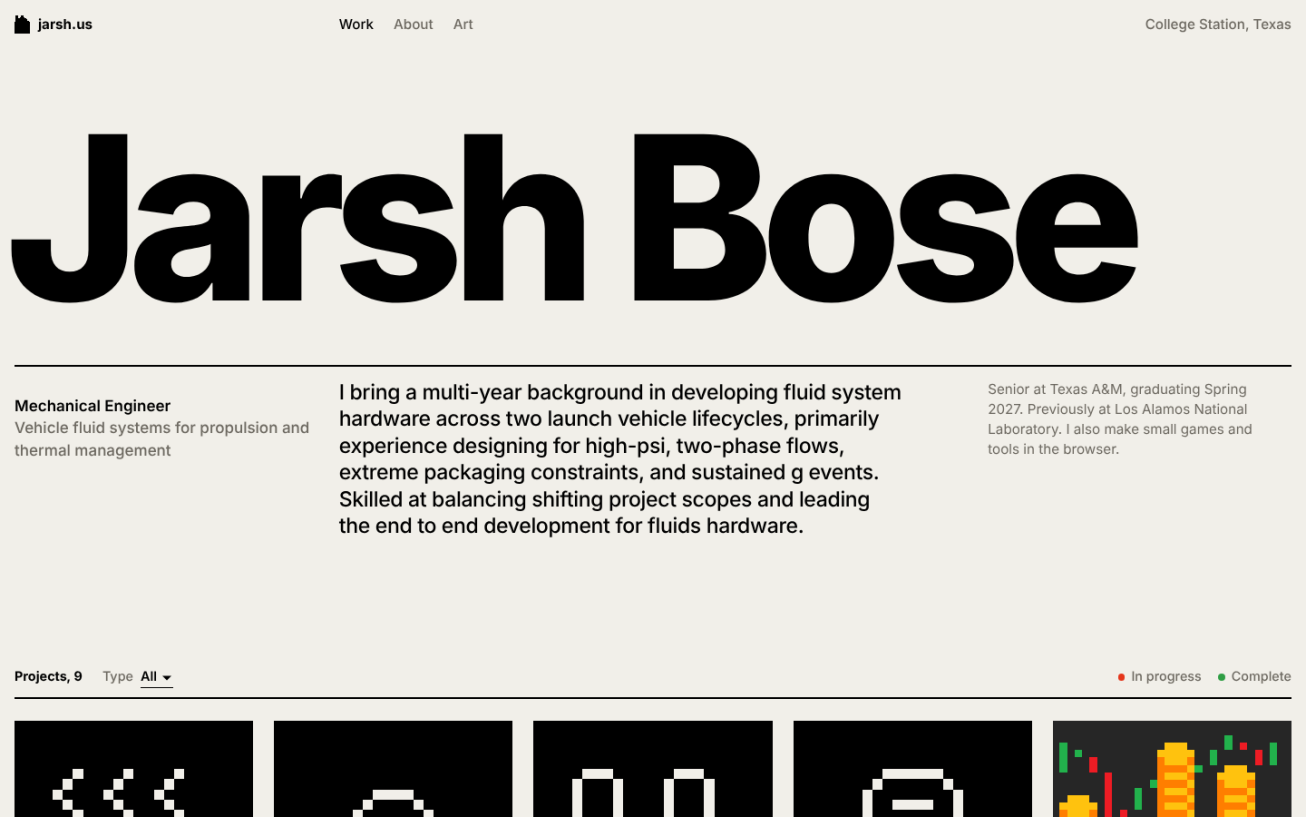
jarsh.us

Development report

Rajarshi Bose October 2026 Site version 1.35

jarsh.us is my portfolio. It collects my engineering work in vehicle fluid systems alongside the games and tools I build on the side. This report covers what the site is for, the design system behind it, how it is built and hosted, and how it changed from its first versioned release to today.



The home page. The name sets in letter by letter, above a three-part introduction on a 12-column grid.

Goals

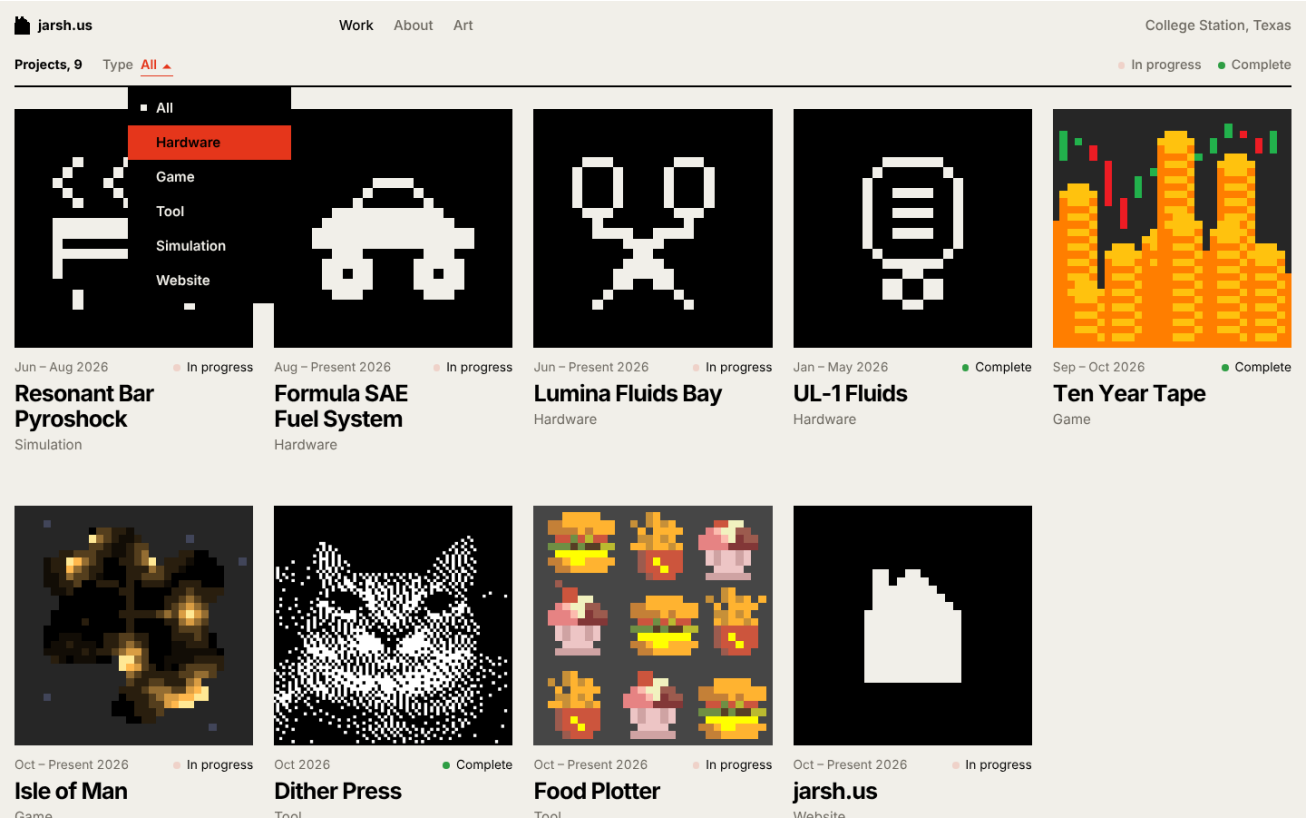
- Show engineering and side projects in one place, readable at a glance by recruiters and graduate admissions committees.
- Look distinctive and typographic rather than templated, using a Swiss approach: one typeface, a strict grid and very little color.
- Stay easy to change: one file, no build step, and a written record of every update.

Design system

Element	Choice	Why
Typeface	Schibsted Grotesk, one family for everything	Hierarchy comes from size and weight alone, which keeps the page quiet and the titles loud.
Color	Paper #F1EFE9, ink #000000, signal red #E5361B, complete green #2F9E44	Red marks interaction and work in progress; green marks finished work. Nothing else is colored.
Grid	12 columns; projects five across, collapsing to three and then two	Every element lines up to the same columns, so the page reads as one system.
Motion	One intro per page, letter rolls on hover, staggered slides when filtering	Motion only answers an action or opens a page, and switches off for visitors who prefer reduced motion.

Features

Feature	What it does
Letter-by-letter titles	Page titles rise into place one letter at a time; project names roll into red copies on hover.
Project index	Each tile shows dates and status; hovering blurs the cover and fades in the summary over a red panel.
Type filter	A custom menu filters by Hardware, Game, Tool, Simulation or Website; tiles slide out, then the filtered set slides up one at a time.
Project pages	Facts, dates, keywords limited to two lines, a written overview and a related-projects bar ranked by shared keywords.
Galleries	Clicking a project image opens a window with the image on the left and captions on the right, with keyboard navigation.
Launchable apps	Games and tools open from their project page; each app carries the same jarsh.us return button in its own colors.
Reports and change log	Projects can offer a downloadable report like this one; every site update is listed in the footer change log.



The project index with the type menu open. Red dots blink for work in progress; green dots mark finished projects.

How it is built and hosted

One file. The whole site is a single index.html with plain HTML, CSS and JavaScript. Projects are a list of entries in the page, and pages are drawn from that list as you click, so adding a project means adding one entry.

Hosting. The site is my GitHub Pages user site, rajarshi-bose.github.io, served at the custom domain jarsh.us with DNS on Cloudflare. GitHub publishes the site automatically on every push.

Apps. Ten Year Tape, Isle of Man, Dither Press and Food Plotter each live in their own repository. Because jarsh.us is the user site, each app appears automatically at jarsh.us/app-name.

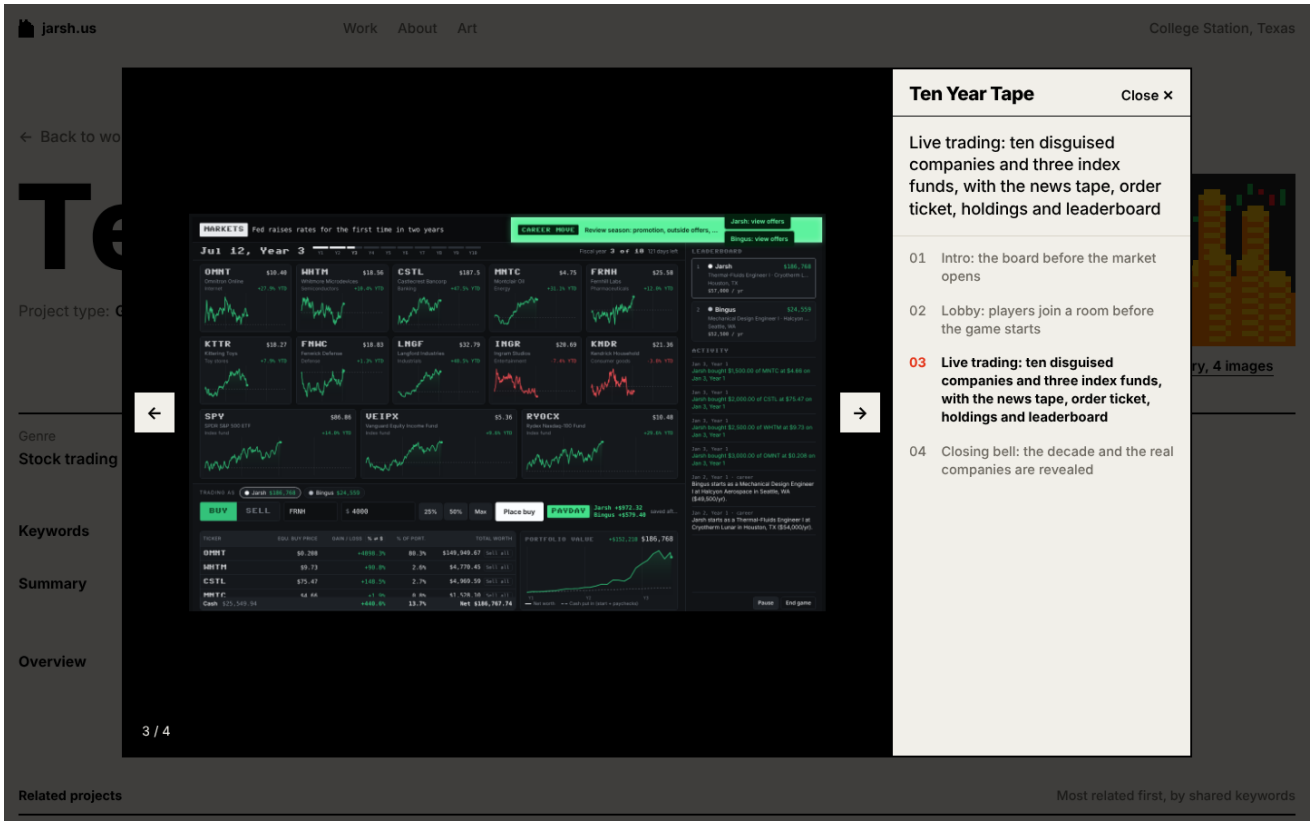
Versioning. Every change raises the version by 0.01 and adds a line to the change log, so the history of the site is readable from the site itself.

Problems solved along the way

Problem	Cause	Fix
Edges of large title letters were cut off	Each letter sat in a clipping box for the rise animation, which also trimmed letters that lean past their box and descenders like the p in Tape.	Clip only the bottom edge, extend the box below the baseline, and start letters lower so they stay hidden before they rise.
A thin light line appeared on covers after hovering	Tiles are fractional pixels wide; as a scaled cover image shrank back it could round one pixel short, exposing a light background in dark mode.	Covers extend one pixel past every edge over a black backing, and the blur moved from the image to the red panel. Verified across 315 captured frames.
Filtering felt heavy	All tiles animated at once, including expensive effects.	Tiles now move with transforms only, slide out together, then slide in one at a time.

Version history

Versions	Date	What changed
1.00	Oct 19	First versioned release: bio, project grid, About and Art pages.
1.01 to 1.05	Oct 19	Body typeface experiments across five monospace faces.
1.06 to 1.13	Oct 19	Click-to-launch art; Dither Press and Isle of Man go live under jarsh.us.
1.14 to 1.18	Oct 19 to 21	Apps move to their own repositories and are served at jarsh.us/app-name; new favicon.
1.19	Oct 22	Swiss redesign: one typeface, 12-column grid, letter animations, status dots.
1.20 to 1.26	Oct 22	New covers, new bio, type filter, month ranges, keywords, related projects and animation fixes.
1.27 to 1.31	Oct 22	Food Plotter added at jarsh.us/food-plotter with its own cover.
1.32 to 1.34	Oct 22	Project galleries with a captioned sidebar.
1.35	Oct 23	jarsh.us added as a project, with this report.



A project gallery. The image fills the left side; the caption and a numbered list of every image sit in the sidebar.

Next steps

- Add photos and captions to the engineering galleries: Lumina Fluids Bay, UL-1 Fluids, Formula SAE and the resonant bar work.
- Write the overview and what-I-did sections for each project, and confirm each project's dates.
- Fill in the About and Art pages.